

Q What opportunities do you see for WishTel's tablet PCs in the Indian market?

There is a huge opportunity in the Indian market and this will continue to grow further with time. The innovations in this segment and the need amongst people to be connected while on the go are the two major factors contributing in this growth. Because Android is common for all, one will see a lot of customisation and localisation that will be rendered to the platform by OEMs like us in terms of local language support, local service support and India-centric apps.

Q Do you find enough development happening in this domain?

There are a lot of companies working in this direction. A lot of training institutes are popping up to teach development on the Android platform. Moreover, a lot of developers are interested in the platform merely because of its popularity. So there is no dearth of innovation on the Android platform. There are a whole lot of apps being built in the service verticals including Customer Relationship Management Solutions, Human Resource Management, GPS tracking, etc.

Q Tablets have been around in India for quite a while now and different OEMs position their devices for different segments. What is the target audience for your products?

We are looking at the education and enterprise segments, which I believe will grow phenomenally in the coming months. Students and companies will adopt tablet PCs as an additional device or instead of a laptop. So the scenario may become one in which people prefer buying tablets rather than laptops.

Q You have quite an elaborate range of Android tablet PCs, but you chose Linux when you launched?

There are two clear distinctions between our products for both the platforms. For Android, the user needs are primarily data and information access, and the computing needs are not very high. PrithV will support more complex computing needs. So, users will be able to run different software, do data modelling, etc.

Q What kind of research did you conduct before bringing out PrithV?

We have done extensive research in terms of user acceptability. We have spoken to people who have been working in this space. I identified that Linux is not being well promoted in India. That is why it is not a preferred platform, as of now.

Q So, how do you plan to promote PrithV?

We want to promote PrithV amongst students first. We will give demonstrations of the tablet to the decision-makers as well, so that they think of Linux as an equally strong alternative to proprietary software.

Q Do you see PrithV being preferred to a general Android tablet?

I can say that both platforms have their merits and both have takers in terms of different user groups. So the need of the users will determine their platform of choice rather than the popularity of the platform.

Q To keep launching such innovative products, do you get the desired talent in India or is the R&D done at a foreign location?

Frankly, regarding the development for this product, it took not only Indian collaborators but also people working internationally. It is totally an Indian development but we took help from people across the globe for their capabilities in different domains. For example, for some of the simulation in Astronomy, we have taken help from experts in the US and Australia. Linux already has a lot of community development happening round the clock. So, that also adds to the value of the product.

"The growth of Android as a tablet platform is yet another reason for us to venture into this segment. If you look at the growth graph of Android devices in the past one year, you will know why every OEM today wants to bring a good Android device into its portfolio"

Q Do you plan to have a separate app store for PrithV?

On Linux, we call it a repository. So in PrithV, the platform would be coming out with its repository. The apps for this platform are being developed in-house as well as with our collaborative partners like the Homi Bhabha Centre of Education.

Q Do you also plan to involve the developers' community in India to work on PrithV?

Yes, we have these plans in the pipeline. Currently, we are inviting programmers on a small scale but soon, we will invite programmers from across the board to develop applications for PrithV and make value-additions to the platform. Existing Linux apps can also work on this platform.

Q One complaint from WishTel users has been the poor build quality. Do you plan to address this?

Yes, we are learning and improving with our products. So, the range launched recently comes with a metal body rather than the plastic one, which is one major value-add we have done to improve the build quality. 